

Network security starts with clear ownership of assets, identities, and data flows. A firewall is only useful when its rules match a written policy. Default-allow rules, unused open ports, and undocumented exceptions are common sources of avoidable risk.

Authentication should prefer phishing-resistant methods such as hardware keys or platform authenticators. Shared passwords, long-lived tokens, and standing administrator access increase blast radius when an account is stolen. Log collection must include authentication failures and privilege changes.

Appendix. Residual notes for operators: review remote-access paths quarterly and retire unused VPN profiles.